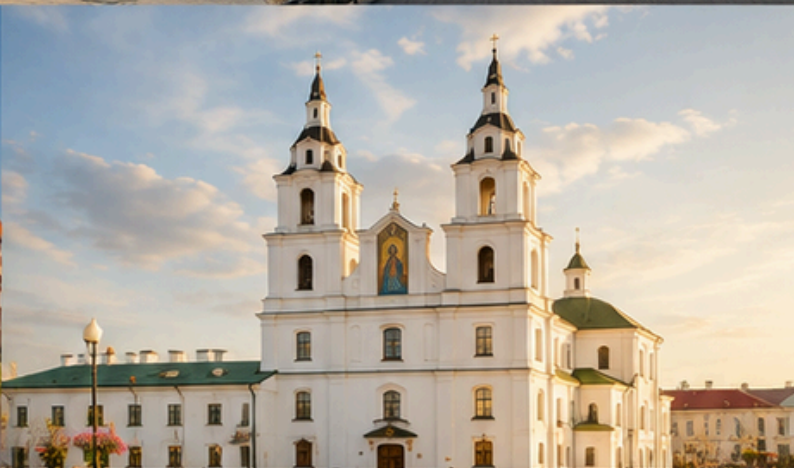
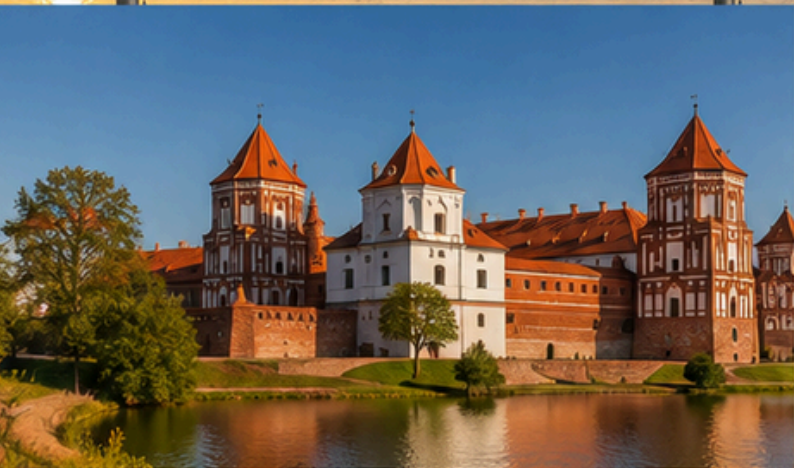




Building Bridges of Partnership, Unlocking New Avenues of Growth.



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August 2026

FOREWORD

India and the Republic of Belarus share a relationship built on mutual respect, longstanding diplomatic engagement, and complementary economic strengths. Over the past three decades, both nations have steadily expanded cooperation across trade, industry, science and technology, education, pharmaceuticals, heavy engineering, agriculture, and cultural exchanges. As the global economic landscape continues to evolve, new opportunities are emerging to elevate this partnership into one driven by innovation, industrial collaboration, resilient supply chains, and sustainable economic growth.

This Knowledge Paper examines the institutional framework governing bilateral relations and presents practical recommendations to strengthen commercial cooperation between the two countries. The study highlights significant potential across a wide range of sectors, including pharmaceuticals, fertilizers, heavy engineering, mining equipment, information technology, agriculture, food processing, renewable energy, biotechnology, logistics, automotive components, education, electronics, and infrastructure. While existing bilateral trade remains modest relative to the size and capabilities of both economies, the complementarities between India's expanding manufacturing and innovation ecosystem and Belarus's industrial and engineering expertise create a strong foundation for long-term collaboration.

Recognising the challenges posed by evolving geopolitical dynamics, global supply-chain realignments, and changing investment patterns, this report identifies actionable strategies that can help businesses navigate emerging opportunities while promoting mutually beneficial partnerships. It also outlines the important role that CCI India can play in facilitating business delegations, investment promotion, technology partnerships, policy dialogue, market intelligence, and institutional collaboration between stakeholders in both countries.

CCI India remains committed to serving as a trusted bridge between governments, industry, investors, and academic institutions. By fostering stronger business-to-business engagement and supporting strategic partnerships, we aim to contribute meaningfully to the next phase of India–Belarus economic relations.



Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

TABLE OF CONTENTS

FOREWORD	2
BELARUS	6
CHAPTER 1: INDIA-BELARUS BILATERAL RELATIONS	9
1.1 HISTORICAL RELATIONS AND DIPLOMATIC ENGAGEMENT.....	9
1.2 POLITICAL COOPERATION AND INSTITUTIONAL MECHANISMS	9
1.3 TRADE AND INVESTMENT RELATIONS	10
1.4 DEFENCE AND TECHNICAL COOPERATION (HIGH-LEVEL OVERVIEW).....	10
1.5 SCIENTIFIC, TECHNICAL, EDUCATION AND CULTURAL RELATIONS	11
1.6 HIGH-LEVEL VISITS	11
1.7 CURRENT STATUS AND FUTURE OUTLOOK	12
CHAPTER 2: BELARUS COUNTRY PROFILE	12
2.1 GEOGRAPHY AND CLIMATE.....	12
2.2 POLITICAL STRUCTURE AND ADMINISTRATIVE DIVISIONS	12
2.3 DEMOGRAPHICS AND HUMAN CAPITAL	13
2.4 ECONOMIC OVERVIEW	13
2.5 NATURAL RESOURCES AND INDUSTRIAL BASE	14
2.6 INVESTMENT CLIMATE	14
2.7 SWOT ANALYSIS.....	15
CHAPTER 3: EMBASSY OF THE REPUBLIC OF BELARUS IN INDIA	16
3.1 OVERVIEW.....	16
3.2 DIPLOMATIC FUNCTIONS	16
3.3 ECONOMIC DIPLOMACY AND TRADE PROMOTION.....	16
3.4 INVESTMENT PROMOTION	17
3.5 CONSULAR SERVICES AND BUSINESS FACILITATION	17
3.6 CULTURAL DIPLOMACY AND EDUCATION & RESEARCH COOPERATION.....	18
3.7 FUTURE PRIORITIES	18
CHAPTER 4: BELARUS INVESTMENT & BUSINESS LANDSCAPE	18
4.1 MACROECONOMIC ENVIRONMENT.....	18
4.2 INDUSTRIAL AND INVESTMENT POLICY	19
4.3 FREE ECONOMIC ZONES AND THE GREAT STONE INDUSTRIAL PARK.....	19
4.4 TAX INCENTIVES BEYOND THE INDUSTRIAL PARKS	20
4.5 FDI TRENDS	20
4.6 EXPORT COMPETITIVENESS	20
4.7 INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITIES FOR INDIAN BUSINESSES	21
4.8 RISKS AND CHALLENGES	21
CHAPTER 5: COMPREHENSIVE SECTORAL ANALYSIS.....	22
5.1 AGRICULTURE & AGRI-BUSINESS	22
5.2 FOOD PROCESSING & DAIRY	23
5.3 FERTILIZERS & CHEMICALS (INCLUDING POTASH)	24
5.4 MANUFACTURING & INDUSTRIAL MACHINERY	25
5.5 MINING & MINING EQUIPMENT	26
5.6 PHARMACEUTICALS & HEALTHCARE.....	27
5.7 INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY & DIGITAL INNOVATION	28
5.8 LOGISTICS & TRANSPORT.....	29

5.9 RENEWABLE ENERGY	30
5.10 AUTOMOTIVE & AUTO COMPONENTS	31
5.11 BIOTECHNOLOGY & LIFE SCIENCES	32
5.12 INFRASTRUCTURE & CONSTRUCTION	33
5.13 EDUCATION, SKILL DEVELOPMENT & RESEARCH	33
5.14 FORESTRY, WOOD PROCESSING & FURNITURE	34
5.15 ELECTRONICS & ELECTRICAL EQUIPMENT	35
CHAPTER 6: CHALLENGES & STRATEGIC COLLABORATION OPPORTUNITIES	36
6.1 INTERNATIONAL SANCTIONS & TRADE CONSTRAINTS	36
<i>Current Situation</i>	36
<i>Root Cause and Economic Impact</i>	37
<i>International Best Practice</i>	37
<i>India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India</i>	37
6.2 EXPORT MARKET DIVERSIFICATION	37
<i>Current Situation</i>	37
<i>Root Cause and Economic Impact</i>	37
<i>International Best Practice</i>	37
<i>India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India</i>	37
6.3 LIMITED FOREIGN DIRECT INVESTMENT	38
<i>Current Situation</i>	38
<i>Root Cause and Economic Impact</i>	38
<i>International Best Practice</i>	38
<i>India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India</i>	38
6.4 DEPENDENCE ON STATE-OWNED ENTERPRISES	38
<i>Current Situation</i>	38
<i>Root Cause and Economic Impact</i>	38
<i>International Best Practice</i>	38
<i>India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India</i>	39
6.5 INDUSTRIAL MODERNISATION	39
<i>Current Situation</i>	39
<i>Root Cause and Economic Impact</i>	39
<i>International Best Practice</i>	39
<i>India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India</i>	39
6.6 TECHNOLOGY TRANSFER	39
<i>Current Situation</i>	39
<i>Root Cause and Economic Impact</i>	39
<i>International Best Practice</i>	39
<i>India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India</i>	40
6.7 LOGISTICS & SUPPLY CHAIN CONNECTIVITY	40
<i>Current Situation</i>	40
<i>Root Cause and Economic Impact</i>	40
<i>International Best Practice</i>	40
<i>India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India</i>	40
6.8 DEMOGRAPHIC & SKILLED WORKFORCE CHALLENGES	40
<i>Current Situation</i>	40
<i>Root Cause and Economic Impact</i>	40
<i>International Best Practice</i>	40
<i>India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India</i>	41
6.9 MSME DEVELOPMENT	41
<i>Current Situation</i>	41
<i>Root Cause and Economic Impact</i>	41
<i>International Best Practice</i>	41

<i>India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India</i>	41
6.10 DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION	41
<i>Current Situation</i>	41
<i>Root Cause and Economic Impact</i>	41
<i>International Best Practice</i>	41
<i>India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India</i>	42
6.11 GREEN INDUSTRIAL TRANSITION AND INTERNATIONAL MARKET ACCESS	42
<i>Current Situation</i>	42
<i>Root Cause and Economic Impact</i>	42
<i>International Best Practice</i>	42
<i>India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India</i>	42
CHAPTER 7: STRATEGIC ROLE OF CCI INDIA	43
7.1 TRADE FACILITATION	43
7.2 INVESTMENT PROMOTION	43
7.3 BUSINESS MATCHMAKING	44
7.4 BUYER–SELLER MEETS	44
7.5 INDUSTRIAL DELEGATIONS	44
7.6 SECTOR WORKING GROUPS	44
7.7 TECHNOLOGY PARTNERSHIPS	45
7.8 STARTUP COLLABORATION	45
7.9 MSME INTERNATIONALISATION	45
7.10 MARKET INTELLIGENCE	46
7.11 SKILL DEVELOPMENT	46
7.12 UNIVERSITY AND RESEARCH PARTNERSHIPS	46
7.13 ANNUAL INDIA–BELARUS BUSINESS FORUM	46
7.14 DIGITAL TRADE PLATFORM	47
7.15 INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK, KPIS, TIMELINE, AND EXPECTED OUTCOMES	47
CHAPTER 8: STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS	48
8.1 RECOMMENDATIONS FOR THE EMBASSY OF BELARUS IN INDIA	48
8.2 RECOMMENDATIONS FOR THE GOVERNMENT OF BELARUS	48
8.3 RECOMMENDATIONS FOR BELARUSIAN BUSINESSES	48
8.4 RECOMMENDATIONS FOR INDIAN BUSINESSES	49
8.5 RECOMMENDATIONS FOR INVESTORS	49
8.6 RECOMMENDATIONS FOR MSMEs	50
8.7 RECOMMENDATIONS FOR STARTUPS	50
CHAPTER 9: FIVE-YEAR STRATEGIC ROADMAP	50
YEAR 1: INSTITUTIONAL FOUNDATION	51
YEAR 2: EARLY ENGAGEMENT	51
YEAR 3: EXPANSION	52
YEAR 4: CONSOLIDATION	52
YEAR 5: INSTITUTIONALISATION	53
CONCLUSION	54

BELARUS

“ Experience quiet towns and local traditions through meaningful and affordable slow travel.



Basic Facts and Economic Overview

Belarus is a landlocked country in Eastern Europe, with Minsk as its capital. As of 2025 projections, the population is approximately 9.0–9.1 million. Belarus operates under a presidential republic system and has close economic and political ties with Russia.

The economy is largely state-controlled, with significant government involvement in key industries such as manufacturing, agriculture, and energy. Belarus has a strong industrial base, particularly in machinery, tractors, chemicals, and fertilizers.

Economy — GDP, Structure & Recent Performance

Belarus's nominal GDP is estimated at approximately USD 75–95 billion (2025).

- Sectoral Composition: Industry: ~50%
- Services: ~40%
- Agriculture: ~8%

Economic growth has been modest, typically around 3.6–3.9% in 2023–24, slowing to ~1% in 2025, constrained by international sanctions and limited market diversification. The country remains heavily dependent on trade with Russia.

Bilateral Trade with India

Trade between India and Belarus is moderate, estimated at approximately USD 100–110 million annually (2024–25). India imports fertilizers and chemicals, while exporting pharmaceuticals, tea, and textiles.

Population

Belarus imports pharmaceuticals, tea, textiles, and small machinery, some of which originate from India either directly or through intermediaries. Direct exports from Belarus to India include fertilizers and chemicals, with additional trade routed through regional supply chains.



“ Cultural and Heritage

Belarus has a rich cultural heritage shaped by Slavic traditions, folk music, dance, and colorful festivals. The country is known for its historic castles, wooden churches, and traditional crafts like weaving and embroidery. Its culture reflects a strong connection to family values, rural life, and centuries-old customs passed through generations.

Import and Export from India

Belarus imports pharmaceuticals, tea, textiles, and small machinery, some of which originate from India either directly or through intermediaries. Direct exports from Belarus to India include fertilizers and chemicals, with additional trade routed through regional supply chains.

Strategic Importance and Key Observation

Belarus holds strategic importance as a transit corridor between Europe and Russia. However, geopolitical tensions and sanctions significantly affect its economic environment.

Opportunities and Risks for Indian Businesses

Opportunities:

- Fertilizer imports
- Pharmaceutical exports
- Machinery and industrial cooperation

Risks:

- Geopolitical instability
- Economic sanctions
- Limited market openness

Cultural and Strategic Economic Ties

India and Belarus share long-standing relations, particularly in pharmaceuticals, education, and defense cooperation. Belarus is a key supplier of potash fertilizers to India.

Conclusion – Summary & Recommendation

Belarus is a state-driven industrial economy with strategic importance in fertilizer supply.

India should focus on securing fertilizer supply chains while cautiously managing geopolitical risks.



Chapter 1: India–Belarus Bilateral Relations

1.1 Historical Relations and Diplomatic Engagement

India and the Republic of Belarus established diplomatic relations in 1992, in the immediate aftermath of Belarus's emergence as an independent state following the dissolution of the Soviet Union. India appointed its first Resident Ambassador to Belarus in January 1993, and Belarus reciprocated by opening its Embassy in New Delhi in 1998. Belarusian consular presence in India was subsequently widened through the establishment of an Honorary Consulate in Kolkata in December 2002 and an Honorary Consulate in Mumbai in September 2018, culminating in the inauguration of a full Belarusian Consulate General in Mumbai in August 2022. This steady deepening of diplomatic footprint reflects the importance both nations attach to expanding engagement beyond the political sphere into commerce, industry, science, and culture.

Over three decades, the relationship has matured into what both governments describe as a comprehensive partnership, characterised by regular political consultation, convergence on major multilateral issues, and an institutionalised architecture of bilateral mechanisms. This foundation of trust and continuity is precisely the kind of relationship on which a substantially larger economic partnership can now be constructed.

This diplomatic groundwork has proven especially valuable during periods of geopolitical turbulence, allowing both governments to maintain a stable channel for dialogue even as Belarus's relations with Western partners came under strain, and providing continuity for the institutional mechanisms described below.

1.2 Political Cooperation and Institutional Mechanisms

Political cooperation between India and Belarus is conducted through several standing mechanisms, most notably Foreign Office Consultations (FOCs), the Inter-Governmental Commission on Trade, Economic, Industrial, Scientific, Technological and Cultural Cooperation (IGC-TEC), and a Joint Commission on Military Technical Cooperation. The seventh round of FOCs was held in New Delhi in August 2022, chaired jointly by India's Secretary (West) and Belarus's First Deputy Foreign Minister. The eleventh session of the IGC-TEC took place on 10 November 2022, co-chaired by the Belarusian Foreign Minister and India's then Minister of State for Commerce & Industry, and included direct engagement with India's Minister of Commerce & Industry.

These mechanisms provide the institutional scaffolding through which trade and investment priorities are negotiated, and they represent an important entry point for CCI India to align its own industry engagement calendar with the government-to-government track, ensuring that private sector priorities are reflected in official deliberations.

The IGC-TEC framework has also spawned sector-specific working arrangements in the past, including on pharmaceuticals and defence-technical cooperation, illustrating that the institutional appetite for deeper sectoral engagement already exists; what has been missing is a standing, business-facing body able to sustain momentum between formal government sessions.

1.3 Trade and Investment Relations

Bilateral trade between India and Belarus, while growing, remains modest relative to the potential of both economies. According to figures compiled by the Embassy of India in Minsk, bilateral trade stood at approximately USD 111.8 million in 2023 and USD 106.69 million in 2025, with the trade balance generally favouring Belarus on account of its potash fertiliser exports to India. India's own Ministry of Commerce data for the 2023–24 fiscal year records total bilateral trade closer to USD 59 million, with India recording a modest trade surplus for that period; the divergence between Indian and Belarusian reporting reflects differences in customs classification, re-routing of trade through third countries, and timing of fiscal-year versus calendar-year reporting, and underscores the need for a harmonised, jointly verified trade database – a role CCI India is well positioned to support.

India's principal exports to Belarus include pharmaceuticals, machinery, organic chemicals, tea, coffee, and tobacco, while India's imports from Belarus are dominated by potash fertilisers, mining and earth-moving equipment, raw hides, and synthetic rubber. On the investment side, cooperation has so far been concentrated in pharmaceuticals: in 2016, Indian and Belarusian companies established three joint ventures in the pharmaceutical sector involving an initial Indian investment of approximately USD 3 million. The Government of India granted Belarus Market Economy Status in 2015, and during the state visit of the President of India to Belarus in June 2015, India extended a USD 100 million Line of Credit to support joint projects.

Beyond BelAZ and mining equipment, cooperation in heavy engineering has extended to periodic technical exchanges between Belarusian and Indian defence-linked manufacturing entities, reflecting the broader pattern of trust that underpins the relationship even in narrowly scoped domains.

1.4 Defence and Technical Cooperation (High-Level Overview)

Defence-technical cooperation forms an established, if narrowly scoped, pillar of the relationship, anchored by a bilateral agreement signed in 2003 and overseen by the Joint Commission on Military Technical Cooperation. Beyond defence, cooperation in mining and heavy engineering has produced tangible outcomes: BelAZ, Belarus's flagship manufacturer of heavy dump trucks, opened a service centre in Nagpur in May 2016, and its 240-tonne capacity trucks have been deployed by Indian company Triveni on infrastructure projects in Andhra Pradesh.

In January 2019, BelAZ secured a tender to supply 77 mining trucks of 136-tonne capacity to Coal India Limited, illustrating the practical, commercially driven cooperation possible between the two countries' industrial sectors. These agreements collectively provide the legal and institutional scaffolding for expanded people-to-people and institutional exchange, and several remain under-utilised relative to their potential, representing low-cost, high-value opportunities for CCI India to help operationalise through concrete programming.

1.5 Scientific, Technical, Education and Cultural Relations

India and Belarus have signed cooperation agreements spanning Friendship and Cooperation (1993), Science & Technology (2007), Investment Promotion (2007), Peaceful Uses of Outer Space (2011), Education (2015), Agriculture (2017), Industrial Cooperation (2017), Culture (2018), and Vocational Education (2019). India's Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation (ITEC) programme and ICCR scholarships have supported the training of Belarusian nationals, while institutional linkages between universities in both countries continue to expand, particularly in engineering, IT, and medicine.

Beyond formal state visits, working-level exchanges between India's Ministry of Commerce & Industry and Belarusian counterpart ministries have continued on a near-annual basis, providing a steady drumbeat of engagement that a dedicated business chamber presence could usefully complement and amplify.

1.6 High-Level Visits

The relationship has been punctuated by a number of high-level visits, most notably the 2015 state visit of the President of India to Belarus, and the participation of Belarus's Foreign Minister in the eleventh IGC-TEC session in New Delhi in 2022. Business delegations have supplemented political exchanges: a CII delegation visited Belarus in June 2018 under the theme 'Exploring New Markets for Business & Investment', an ASSOCHAM delegation visited Minsk in November 2021, an eight-member FICCI delegation visited Minsk in December 2023 for B2B meetings, and nineteen Indian companies participated in the 'Healthcare of Belarus' international medical forum in May 2022.

Both sides have also indicated openness to exploring a preferential or free trade arrangement, whether bilaterally or through the India–EAEU track, which, if pursued, would materially change the tariff and market-access calculus for Indian exporters and could accelerate the sectoral opportunities identified throughout this paper.

1.7 Current Status and Future Outlook

The current state of India–Belarus relations can be characterised as politically warm, institutionally well-organised, but economically under-realised. Both governments have repeatedly acknowledged that bilateral trade and investment fall well short of potential, and both have signalled willingness to diversify cooperation beyond the traditional potash-for-pharmaceuticals pattern into machinery, IT, agro-processing, renewable energy, and skill development. The entry of an active institutional facilitator such as CCI India capable of running sustained business-matchmaking, sectoral working groups, and a joint digital trade platform represents the missing link that can convert political goodwill into measurable commercial outcomes over the next five years.

Chapter 2: Belarus Country Profile

2.1 Geography and Climate

The Republic of Belarus is a landlocked country in Eastern Europe, bordered by Latvia and Lithuania to the north-west, Poland to the west, the Russian Federation to the north-east and east, and Ukraine to the south. Its location places it at the crossroads of major transit corridors linking the European Union, Russia, and the wider Eurasian space, a geography that has historically underpinned its role as a transport and logistics hub. The climate is continental, with cold winters and mild, moderately warm summers, supporting a well-developed agricultural base in grain, potatoes, sugar beet, flax, and dairy and livestock farming.

Belarus's continental climate and fertile chernozem-adjacent soils in its southern regions support a growing-season profile well suited to grain, oilseed, and fodder-crop cultivation, while its extensive river network (the Dnieper, Neman, and Western Dvina) and inland waterways provide additional logistics options for bulk agricultural and industrial cargo alongside road and rail.

2.2 Political Structure and Administrative Divisions

Belarus is a presidential republic with a centralized system of governance. Administratively, the country is divided into six regions (voblasts) Brest, Homyel, Hrodna, Mahilyou, Minsk, and Vitsebsk along with the city of Minsk, which enjoys special administrative status as the national capital. The Belarusian economy remains largely state-directed, with state-owned enterprises accounting for a significant share of industrial production, particularly in key sectors such as machinery manufacturing, chemicals, energy, and heavy industry. This governance model has enabled the country to maintain a strong industrial base while exercising substantial state oversight over strategic economic activities.

Belarus additionally reports low income inequality by regional standards and near-universal access to basic healthcare and secondary education, both legacies of the Soviet-era social model that the state has continued to fund. For Indian partners, this translates into a disciplined, technically literate workforce that can be onboarded into joint ventures and technical-collaboration projects with comparatively limited additional training investment.

2.3 Demographics and Human Capital

Belarus has a population of approximately 9.1 million. The country has a well-educated, urbanised population with a literacy rate above 99 percent and a strong tradition of technical and engineering education. Belarus's Human Development Index stands in the 'very high' category, reflecting substantial investment in education and healthcare infrastructure inherited from and expanded upon the Soviet-era system. The labour force numbers close to 4.8 million, with services accounting for the largest share of employment, followed by industry and agriculture. An ageing population profile and a fertility rate below replacement level, however, present a long-term workforce challenge that industrial policy and inward investment will need to address.

The state budget has generally been managed conservatively, with public debt levels moderate by regional comparison, though the fiscal space for large new stimulus programmes remains constrained by limited access to international capital markets. The National Bank of the Republic of Belarus has kept monetary policy oriented toward exchange-rate and price stability, which, combined with capital controls, has helped contain currency volatility despite the broader sanctions environment.

2.4 Economic Overview

Belarus is classified by the World Bank as an upper-middle-income economy with a mixed economic model combining a substantial state-owned enterprise sector with an increasingly active private and IT-driven segment. National and international estimates of nominal GDP vary depending on methodology and year, generally ranging between USD 70 billion and USD 90 billion, with GDP per capita in the range of roughly USD 8,000 to USD 10,000 in nominal terms and considerably higher in the region of USD 30,000–35,000 when measured on a purchasing power parity basis. The economy grew by an estimated 3.6 percent in 2024, but growth is projected by the World Bank to moderate to below 2 percent in 2025 and around 1 percent in 2026, reflecting continued softness in demand from Russia, Belarus's largest trading partner, and the broader impact of international sanctions on export channels.

Inflation has moderated from the sharp spikes experienced earlier in the decade but remains elevated by regional standards, with recent estimates placing consumer price inflation in the range of approximately 5 to 6 percent. Sectorally, industry (including manufacturing) contributes roughly 40 percent of GDP, services around 51 percent, and agriculture around 8 percent, underscoring Belarus's continued identity as a manufacturing and engineering economy rather than a purely service-based one.

Belarus's timber and wood-processing base, covering more than 40 percent of national territory under forest cover, complements its mineral and industrial resource endowment and provides an additional, currently under-tapped, avenue for export diversification toward Asian markets, including India, as traditional European outlets have contracted.

2.5 Natural Resources and Industrial Base

Belarus's principal natural resource endowment is potash, of which it is among the largest global producers and exporters; potassium chloride exports to India reached record volumes in 2020 and grew further in value terms in 2021. Beyond potash, the country possesses reserves of peat, limestone, and modest oil and gas resources. Its industrial base is centred on heavy engineering and machinery including tractors, heavy trucks, earth-moving equipment, and agricultural machinery alongside petrochemicals, synthetic fibres, fertilisers, textiles, and household appliances. This machinery-building tradition, exemplified by globally recognised manufacturers, provides a natural complementarity with India's large infrastructure, mining, and agricultural-mechanisation markets.

Investor protections in Belarus include guarantees against expropriation, dispute-resolution mechanisms referencing international arbitration frameworks, and repatriation rights for profits, though in practice due-diligence timelines and banking-channel complexity linked to sanctions compliance mean that Indian investors should budget additional time and specialist advisory support during structuring and fund transfer.

2.6 Investment Climate

Belarus has, over the past decade, sought to position itself as an investment destination through targeted incentives, most visibly through the China–Belarus Industrial Park 'Great Stone' and a network of Free Economic Zones offering tax and customs concessions to resident investors. International sanctions imposed since 2021 have, however, constrained access to Western capital markets and technology, pushing Belarus to intensify economic reorientation toward Russia, China, and non-Western partners such as India, the Gulf states, and Southeast Asia. For Indian investors, this reorientation creates a window of opportunity: Belarus is actively seeking alternative sources of capital, technology, and market access, and is likely to offer favourable terms to Indian partners willing to engage in sectors such as pharmaceuticals, IT services, agro-processing, and machinery component manufacturing.

Strengths include an educated, technically skilled workforce, an established heavy-engineering and pharmaceutical manufacturing base, and strategically located free economic zones with generous fiscal incentives. Weaknesses include over-dependence on the Russian market, constrained access to Western capital and technology, and an ageing population. Opportunities lie in diversification toward India and other non-Western partners across pharmaceuticals, machinery, agro-processing, and IT services. Threats include further sanctions escalation, prolonged logistics disruption, and slower-than-expected reorientation of trade flows away from traditional markets.

2.7 SWOT Analysis

Dimension	Key Factors
Strengths	Strong engineering and machinery-building base; skilled, technically trained workforce; well-developed potash and chemicals industry; strategic geographic location between the EU and Eurasian space; mature IT and software services sector.
Weaknesses	Heavy dependence on the Russian market and on state-owned enterprises; limited access to Western capital and technology under current sanctions; ageing demographic profile; underdeveloped direct trade and logistics linkages with South Asia.
Opportunities	Diversification of export markets toward India, ASEAN, the Gulf, and Africa; joint ventures in pharmaceuticals, agro-processing and machinery; technology and skill partnerships with Indian IT and engineering firms; Free Economic Zone incentives for new foreign investors.
Threats	Continued external sanctions and trade restrictions; currency and macroeconomic volatility; slow structural reform of state enterprises; competition from other Eurasian Economic Union suppliers for the Indian market.

Taken together, Belarus's SWOT profile suggests that its most promising near-term path to deeper economic engagement with India lies not in broad-based liberalisation, but in targeted, sector-specific partnerships particularly in pharmaceuticals, heavy machinery, potash-linked agro-inputs, and IT services where complementarities with the Indian economy are strongest and where institutional facilitation, of the kind CCI India is positioned to provide, can meaningfully accelerate outcomes.

Chapter 3: Embassy of the Republic of Belarus in India

3.1 Overview

The Embassy of the Republic of Belarus in New Delhi, established in 1998, is the principal institutional channel through which Belarus conducts its bilateral relationship with India. It is currently headed by H.E. Mikhail M. Kasko, Ambassador Extraordinary and Plenipotentiary of the Republic of Belarus to the Republic of India. The Embassy's jurisdiction covers the whole of India, and it is supported by a Consulate General in Mumbai (inaugurated in August 2022) and an Honorary Consulate in Kolkata (established in December 2002), giving Belarus a three-city diplomatic and commercial footprint across North, West, and East India.

The Embassy also plays a coordinating role during high-level visits and institutional dialogues, liaising with India's Ministry of External Affairs and Ministry of Commerce & Industry to ensure that commercial priorities are reflected on official agendas alongside political and strategic considerations.

3.2 Diplomatic Functions

In its core diplomatic capacity, the Embassy represents the Government of the Republic of Belarus on political, economic, cultural, and consular matters, and services the interests of Belarusian nationals resident in or visiting India. It also serves as the Indian-side secretariat counterpart for recurring bilateral mechanisms – Foreign Office Consultations and the Inter-Governmental Commission on Trade, Economic, Industrial, Scientific, Technological and Cultural Cooperation – feeding Indian business and government perspectives back into Minsk's policy process.

The Embassy's economic diplomacy function has increasingly focused on curating introductions between Belarusian state enterprises and Indian private-sector counterparts, a role that a dedicated CCI India Belarus Desk could meaningfully scale by providing sustained, business-led follow-through between Embassy-facilitated introductions.

3.3 Economic Diplomacy and Trade Promotion

Economic diplomacy has become an increasingly central function of the Embassy in recent years, reflecting Belarus's strategic pivot toward new markets following the tightening of Western sanctions. The Embassy actively supports Belarusian exporters seeking entry into the Indian market – particularly in potash fertilisers, machinery, and mining equipment – and works to attract Indian business delegations to Belarusian trade fairs and investment forums, such as the 'Healthcare of Belarus' medical forum, which drew nineteen Indian companies in May 2022.

It also liaises with Indian industry bodies including FICCI, ASSOCHAM, and CII, which have each led business delegations to Minsk in recent years. Investment promotion activity has to date been constrained by limited dedicated staffing capacity within the Embassy's commercial section, underscoring the value of a structured partnership with an institution such as CCI India that can extend the Embassy's outreach capacity without requiring additional diplomatic headcount.

3.4 Investment Promotion

On investment promotion, the Embassy works in coordination with Belarus's National Agency of Investment and Privatisation and the Ministry of Economy to profile opportunities in the Great Stone Industrial Park and Belarus's network of Free Economic Zones to Indian investors, and to facilitate due-diligence introductions for Indian companies considering joint ventures, of the kind already established in the pharmaceutical sector. A more active and systematic promotion effort potentially in direct partnership with CCI India could meaningfully expand the currently narrow base of Indian investment in Belarus.

Business facilitation support extends to guidance on documentation requirements for trade fairs, exhibitions, and short-term business travel, an area where closer coordination with CCI India's delegation-planning function could reduce administrative friction for first-time Indian visitors to Belarus.

3.5 Consular Services and Business Facilitation

The Embassy's consular wing handles visa issuance, passport services, and protection of Belarusian nationals, while its Mumbai Consulate General extends dedicated business-facilitation support to India's principal commercial and financial hub. For Indian businesses, the Embassy is typically the first point of contact for visa facilitation for delegations travelling to Belarus, document attestation, and initial introductions to Belarusian regulatory authorities and chambers of commerce.

Education and research cooperation channelled through the Embassy has historically centred on scholarship administration and academic-exchange facilitation; deepening this into structured university-to-university partnerships, as proposed elsewhere in this paper, would represent a natural extension of the Embassy's existing cultural-diplomacy mandate.

3.6 Cultural Diplomacy and Education & Research Cooperation

Cultural diplomacy including participation in Indian cultural festivals, film weeks, and academic exchanges supports the broader relationship by building people-to-people familiarity that underpins commercial trust. On education, the Embassy works alongside Indian ITEC and ICCR scholarship frameworks and supports emerging university-to-university linkages in engineering, medicine, and IT, building the human-capital foundation for deeper industrial cooperation over time.

Looking ahead, the Embassy has signalled interest in a more systematic, sector-by-sector approach to economic engagement, moving beyond episodic delegation visits toward the kind of standing institutional architecture that CCI India is well positioned to help build and sustain.

3.7 Future Priorities

Looking ahead, the Embassy's stated priorities align closely with the broader strategic direction of this report: diversifying bilateral trade beyond potash and pharmaceuticals; attracting Indian investment into Belarusian manufacturing, IT, and agro-processing; expanding institutional partnerships with Indian chambers of commerce, including a more structured and sustained relationship with CCI India; and using high-level visits and the IGC-TEC mechanism to set measurable targets for trade and investment growth over the next five years.

Chapter 4: Belarus Investment & Business Landscape

4.1 Macroeconomic Environment

Belarus's macroeconomic environment is shaped by a mixed economy with a dominant state sector, moderate but decelerating growth, and inflation running above regional norms. Real GDP growth is estimated to have slowed from roughly 3.6 percent in 2024 to under 2 percent in 2025, with the World Bank projecting growth around 1.1 percent in 2026 and 0.7–0.8 percent in 2027–2028, largely reflecting subdued demand from Russia, Belarus's dominant trading partner. For prospective Indian investors, this suggests a market where growth is currently modest but stable, and where diversification of trading partners including toward India is an explicit policy priority of the Belarusian government rather than a marginal consideration.

The National Bank's policy stance has prioritised containing inflation while supporting continued access to credit for priority industrial sectors, with directed lending programmes channelling concessional finance toward modernisation projects in machine-building, pharmaceuticals, and agro-processing that align closely with the sectors of greatest interest to Indian investors.

4.2 Industrial and Investment Policy

Belarusian industrial policy continues to prioritise modernisation of its traditional engineering and machinery-building base, supported by state investment programmes and international technical cooperation, alongside a deliberate strategy of attracting foreign capital through special economic zones. Investment policy is anchored in the 2007 Investment Promotion Agreement with India (among similar agreements with other partners), Belarus's Investment Code, and a series of presidential decrees establishing preferential regimes for priority zones and sectors.

Resident companies in Belarus's Free Economic Zones benefit from exemption from profit tax for defined periods (commonly up to ten years, depending on the zone and investment size), together with import-duty exemptions on equipment and raw materials brought in for production, subject to minimum investment and local value-addition thresholds that vary by zone and should be confirmed with each FEZ administration ahead of project structuring.

4.3 Free Economic Zones and the Great Stone Industrial Park

Belarus operates a network of Free Economic Zones (FEZs) across its six regions, offering resident companies exemptions or reductions on profit tax, land tax, real estate tax, and import duties on production equipment, together with simplified customs procedures. The flagship investment vehicle, however, is the China–Belarus Great Stone Industrial Park, located 25 kilometres from Minsk with direct access to Minsk National Airport and major European and Eurasian highway and rail corridors. Great Stone residents benefit from a ten-year exemption from profit tax (reduced by half thereafter until 2062), exemption from land and real estate tax for the duration of the special legal regime, duty-free import of production machinery, and a 'one-stop-shop' administrative service covering registration, customs, and land allocation. The Park has attracted resident companies from more than fifteen countries across mechanical engineering, electronics and telecommunications, fine chemistry, biotechnology, pharmaceuticals, new materials, and logistics sectors that map closely onto India's own industrial and pharmaceutical export strengths, making Great Stone a natural landing site for an initial wave of Indian manufacturing and logistics investment in Belarus.

High-Tech Park residents, in particular, benefit from a distinctive legal and tax regime that includes a preferential personal income tax rate for employees, simplified currency-control procedures for export transactions, and an extraterritoriality principle allowing residency without a physical office presence in the Park, features that have made the HTP regime attractive to a wide range of foreign IT investors beyond Belarus's traditional partners.

4.4 Tax Incentives Beyond the Industrial Parks

Outside the FEZs and Great Stone, general corporate profit tax in Belarus stands at 20 percent, with reduced rates and targeted holidays available for high-tech, IT, and innovation-driven enterprises, most notably through the Hi-Tech Park regime that has underpinned Belarus's well-regarded IT and software export industry. Employer payroll tax burdens within preferential zones can be substantially below the national rate, further improving the cost competitiveness of labour-intensive manufacturing and back-office operations.

The composition of remaining FDI has shifted markedly toward China, Russia, and a growing number of Gulf and Asian investors willing to accept the compliance overhead associated with sanctioned-economy exposure, a pattern that mirrors the broader reorientation of Belarusian trade and suggests that Indian capital entering now would face comparatively less competitive crowding than it would have prior to 2021.

4.5 FDI Trends

Foreign direct investment into Belarus has been constrained since 2021 by international sanctions that limit access to Western capital markets and technology transfer, prompting a marked reorientation of inbound investment toward Russia, China, and non-Western partners. This reorientation is precisely the strategic opening that India-linked investment can occupy: Belarus's government has publicly and repeatedly signalled its interest in diversifying its investor base, and Indian pharmaceutical, IT, agro-processing, and engineering companies face comparatively little of the geopolitical friction that constrains Western investors.

Belarusian exporters have increasingly turned to trade-finance and payment mechanisms outside the conventional SWIFT-dependent Western banking channels, including bilateral currency-settlement arrangements with several partner countries, a trend that Indian exporters and importers engaging with Belarusian counterparts should factor into their own payment-structuring discussions.

4.6 Export Competitiveness

Belarus's export competitiveness rests on three pillars: potash and mineral fertilisers, where it remains among the world's largest producers; heavy engineering and machinery, including tractors, trucks, and mining equipment produced by globally recognised Belarusian manufacturers; and a growing IT and software services sector benefiting from a strong technical education base. Tariff-free access to the 183-million-consumer Eurasian Economic Union market further enhances the attractiveness of Belarus as a manufacturing base for companies including Indian companies seeking to serve Russia, Kazakhstan, and neighbouring EAEU markets without separately negotiating market access in each.

4.7 Investment Opportunities for Indian Businesses

- Pharmaceutical manufacturing joint ventures, building on the existing base of three Indian-linked pharma JVs established in 2016.
- Agro-processing and food-technology investment, leveraging Belarus's dairy, grain, and potato production base and India's food-processing expertise.
- Heavy machinery component manufacturing and after-sales service, extending the BelAZ–Coal India and BelAZ–Triveni model to other Indian infrastructure and mining companies.
- IT and software services partnerships, linking Indian IT firms with Belarus's Hi-Tech Park ecosystem for co-development and nearshoring arrangements serving European clients.
- Logistics and warehousing investment within the Great Stone Industrial Park, positioning Indian firms to serve both the EAEU and onward European markets.

Given the compressed timelines and specialised documentation typically required for FEZ and Great Stone registration, Indian businesses are strongly advised to engage local legal and tax counsel, alongside CCI India's investment-promotion function, from the earliest stages of project scoping rather than after a preliminary decision to invest has already been made.

4.8 Risks and Challenges

Indian investors should weigh several risks: continued exposure to international sanctions affecting cross-border payments and select technology transfers; currency and macroeconomic volatility linked to Belarus's dependence on the Russian economic cycle; the administrative weight of a still-substantial state-owned enterprise sector in some industries; and comparatively underdeveloped direct logistics and banking linkages between India and Belarus, which currently require routing through third countries for both trade finance and physical shipment. These risks are manageable but require careful structuring – an area where CCI India, in partnership with the Embassy, can provide practical advisory support to first-time Indian investors.

Currency-conversion and profit-repatriation procedures, while formally guaranteed, can involve additional documentation and processing time linked to sanctions-compliance checks by correspondent banks; Indian investors should build contingency time into transaction planning and, where possible, engage banking partners with established experience handling Belarus-linked transactions.

Chapter 5: Comprehensive Sectoral Analysis

This chapter examines fifteen priority sectors for India–Belarus industrial cooperation. Each sector assessment covers current status and verified statistics, the policy framework, key industry players, principal challenges, investment opportunities, the outlook to 2030, the specific potential for India–Belarus collaboration, and the strategic role CCI India can play in accelerating outcomes.

5.1 Agriculture & Agri-Business

Overview and Current Status

Agriculture remains a strategic pillar of the Belarusian economy, contributing approximately 7 percent of GDP and absorbing more than 16 percent of fixed-capital investment. Belarus has achieved a high degree of food self-sufficiency, producing roughly 256 percent of domestic milk requirements, 176 percent of sugar needs, 232 percent of vegetable oil needs, and around 135 percent of meat needs, positioning the country as a consistent net food exporter. In 2025, Belarus recorded its highest-ever food and agricultural raw material exports at approximately USD 10 billion, equivalent to roughly a quarter of total merchandise exports, shipped to 116 countries.

Policy Framework and Key Players

State policy continues to prioritise deep processing of raw agricultural output, scientific and technical support to producers, and active export diversification toward Asia, Africa, the Middle East, and the Gulf as traditional European markets have become constrained. Belarus's agricultural machinery base – most notably Minsk Tractor Works (MTZ), one of the world's largest tractor manufacturers by volume – provides an integrated domestic supply chain from mechanisation through to primary production.

Challenges

Key constraints include an ageing rural workforce, continued reliance on state-directed production targets in parts of the sector, logistical distance from non-CIS markets, and exposure to weather-related yield volatility.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

For India, Belarus's agricultural machinery expertise (tractors, harvesters, tillage equipment) is directly relevant to India's own farm-mechanisation drive, while Belarus's seed technology, dairy-farm management systems, and cold-chain deep-processing know-how offer transferable models for Indian agri-business. CCI India can facilitate this cooperation by organising joint agri-technology working groups, supporting MTZ-linked assembly or distribution partnerships with Indian farm equipment companies, and connecting Indian agri-tech and cold-chain firms with Belarusian state agricultural enterprises seeking modernisation partners.

Recommendation: CCI India should convene an India–Belarus Agri-Machinery Roundtable within 12 months to scope at least two pilot joint ventures in farm equipment assembly or distribution. India's own dairy cooperative model, exemplified by large-scale producer organisations, offers a potential template for structuring Belarusian export partnerships that go beyond one-off trading relationships toward more durable supply agreements, particularly for milk-powder and long-shelf-life dairy products suited to India's distribution geography.

5.2 Food Processing & Dairy

Overview and Current Status

Dairy is the single largest component of Belarus's food export basket, accounting for approximately 40 percent of total food exports and roughly half of agricultural output. Belarus maintains a dairy herd of about 1.5 million cows, processes approximately 6.2 million tonnes of milk annually, and produces around 200,000 tonnes of cheese and 100,000 tonnes of milk powder and whey products each year, with dairy exports reaching close to USD 4 billion and shipments to 69 countries. Meat processing is the second-largest category, at around 19 percent of food exports, with 19 major meat-processing enterprises supplying approximately 20 countries.

Policy Framework and Key Players

The government's agro-industrial modernisation programme includes plans for roughly 48 new modern dairy complexes in 2026 alone, with modern facilities already accounting for approximately 80 percent of total milk production. State-affiliated dairy and meat combines dominate production and export, operating under quality and safety standards that have earned Belarus a strong ranking on the Global Food Security Index.

Challenges

The sector faces continued over-dependence on the Russian and CIS markets (which absorb the bulk of exports), counterfeit and quality-assurance issues in some destination markets, and limited direct logistics connectivity to South Asian buyers.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

India's large and growing processed-dairy market, combined with Belarus's proven capability in cheese, butter, and milk-powder processing, presents a natural complementarity either through direct Belarusian exports of specialty dairy ingredients to Indian processors, or through joint-venture dairy processing investment in India using Belarusian equipment and technical know-how. CCI India can support this by organising buyer-seller meets between Belarusian dairy combines and Indian dairy cooperatives/processors, and by helping Belarusian exporters navigate India's FSSAI import certification requirements.

Recommendation: CCI India should facilitate at least one India–Belarus dairy-sector buyer-seller mission within 18 months, targeting specialty cheese, whey, and milk-powder trade. Given India's status as one of the world's largest fertiliser consumers and a structural net importer of potash, a long-term offtake or joint-venture arrangement with Belaruskali-linked entities could offer Indian fertiliser companies a degree of supply-side price and volume predictability that is increasingly valuable amid global potash market volatility.

5.3 Fertilizers & Chemicals (including Potash)

Overview and Current Status

Potash is Belarus's flagship export commodity and a pillar of the broader chemicals sector. State producer Belaruskali is among the world's largest potash producers, historically controlling around 16–20 percent of global market share, with potash production estimated at approximately 6 million tonnes in 2025 (up from around 5 million tonnes in 2024) against reserves of roughly 750 million tonnes. Potash-related exports generated over USD 1 billion in 2024, with China, Brazil, and India historically together accounting for roughly half of all Belarusian potash sales.

Policy Framework and Key Players

Since 2021, EU and US sanctions targeting Belaruskali and its export arm, the Belarusian Potash Company, have forced a costly rerouting of exports away from the Lithuanian port of Klaipėda toward Russian rail and port infrastructure, raising logistics costs. A partial easing of US financial sanctions on Belaruskali was announced in March 2026 in connection with a prisoner-release agreement, though EU restrictions remain in force, and EU carbon border duties on Belarusian fertiliser are scheduled to rise substantially through 2028.

Challenges

The sector's principal challenges are logistics-route dependency on Russia, exposure to further sanctions escalation, rising EU tariff barriers, and long-term global supply diversification (new potash capacity coming online in Canada, Russia, Laos, Spain, Morocco, and Brazil) that will increase competitive pressure on Belarusian volumes.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

India is already one of Belarus's most important potash buyers and, as a large net importer of potash for its domestic fertiliser industry, has a direct interest in securing reliable, long-term supply contracts, potentially including rupee-denominated payment arrangements that sidestep some sanctions-related banking friction. CCI India can play a valuable role by supporting Indian fertiliser companies and cooperatives in negotiating long-term offtake agreements directly with Belaruskali/BPC, and by working with the Embassy to explore alternative logistics corridors (e.g., via Iran's Chabahar port or other non-Baltic routes) for direct Belarus–India potash shipment.

Recommendation: CCI India should establish a standing India–Belarus Potash Trade Working Group within 6 months to pursue a multi-year offtake framework and evaluate alternative shipping corridors. Indian machine-tool and capital-goods manufacturers could explore component co-production arrangements with Belarusian machinery plants, combining India's lower-cost manufacturing base with Belarus's established design and precision-engineering capabilities to jointly target price-sensitive markets in South Asia, Africa, and the Middle East.

5.4 Manufacturing & Industrial Machinery

Overview and Current Status

Heavy engineering and machinery-building is Belarus's traditional industrial strength, encompassing tractors, trucks, agricultural machinery, and industrial equipment. Minsk Tractor Works (MTZ) is among the largest tractor manufacturers globally by unit volume, exporting to dozens of countries, while other major machine-building enterprises produce metal-cutting tools, refrigeration equipment, and household appliances. Industry contributes roughly 40 percent of Belarusian GDP, with machinery and equipment a significant share of that base.

Policy Framework and Key Players

Government policy supports continued modernisation of machine-building enterprises through state investment programmes, technical cooperation agreements (including the 2017 India–Belarus Industrial Cooperation Agreement), and preferential regimes for component localisation. Key state enterprises include MTZ, MAZ (trucks and buses), and a range of specialised machinery producers.

Challenges

Constraints include ageing capital stock in some plants, sanctions-driven loss of access to certain Western components and machine tools, and the need to compete against lower-cost Asian machinery exporters in third markets.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

India's large and growing market for tractors, construction equipment, and industrial machinery alongside its own component manufacturing base presents opportunities for MTZ- and MAZ-linked assembly, component-sourcing, and co-manufacturing arrangements in India, potentially anchored in existing industrial corridors. CCI India can facilitate technical delegations between Indian auto-component clusters (e.g., Pune, Chennai, Ludhiana) and Belarusian machine-building enterprises, and support joint pursuit of the 2017 Industrial Cooperation Agreement's unrealised potential.

Recommendation: CCI India should organise an annual India–Belarus Machinery & Components Business Forum, with the first edition targeted within 12–18 months. Beyond BelAZ, opportunities exist for Indian mining-services companies to explore maintenance, spare-parts distribution, and operator-training partnerships that extend the commercial relationship beyond equipment sales into longer-term service contracts, a model that has proven durable for other international heavy-equipment brands operating in India.

5.5 Mining & Mining Equipment

Overview and Current Status

Belarus's mining sector is defined principally by potash extraction and by its globally recognised heavy mining-equipment manufacturer, BelAZ, one of the world's leading producers of large-capacity dump trucks used in open-pit mining. BelAZ vehicles of up to 240-tonne capacity are already operating in India, and the company has previously won competitive tenders to supply Coal India Limited.

Policy Framework and Key Players

BelAZ maintains an established service and support presence in India, including a dedicated service centre in Nagpur opened in 2016, and works with Indian partners such as Triveni Engineering on infrastructure projects. Belarusian mining-sector policy supports continued export promotion of BelAZ equipment as a strategic non-potash foreign-currency earner.

Challenges

Challenges include competition from other international heavy-equipment manufacturers, financing constraints for large capital-equipment purchases by Indian buyers, and the need to expand after-sales parts and service networks across India's dispersed mining regions.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

The existing BelAZ–Coal India and BelAZ–Triveni relationships provide a proven template for expansion into other Indian public-sector mining companies and private infrastructure contractors. CCI India can support BelAZ's Indian expansion by facilitating introductions to state mining corporations beyond Coal India (e.g., NMDC, Singareni Collieries), and by supporting the development of a wider component and service-parts distribution network across Indian mining hubs.

Recommendation: CCI India should support a targeted BelAZ market-expansion programme aimed at securing at least two additional Indian public-sector mining contracts within three years. India's pharmaceutical exporters could also explore contract manufacturing and technology licensing arrangements with Belarusian producers seeking to diversify their raw material and formulation technology sourcing, supported by existing bilateral cooperation agreements.

5.6 Pharmaceuticals & Healthcare

Overview and Current Status

Belarus's pharmaceutical sector, anchored by the state Belpharmprom holding company and enterprises such as Belmedpreparaty, produced output worth roughly USD 800 million in 2024, manufacturing more than 1,600 registered domestic medicine names. Pharmaceutical exports reached approximately USD 206–222 million in 2024–2025, shipped to around 30 countries, while domestically produced medicines account for roughly 50 percent of the home market in value terms and up to 80 percent of the hospital sector by volume.

Policy Framework and Key Players

Belarusian health policy targets raising the domestic-medicine market share to at least 75 percent over the next five-year plan, backed by a pipeline of 17 investment projects worth approximately BYN 1 billion, and is actively pursuing new export markets in Southeast Asia, Latin America, and the Gulf. Belpharmprom enterprises account for the majority of national pharmaceutical output and export.

Challenges

The industry remains dependent on imported active pharmaceutical ingredients (APIs) for a significant share of production, faces regulatory harmonisation hurdles when entering new markets, and competes with larger, lower-cost generic producers, including from India itself.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

Pharmaceuticals is already the most developed area of Indian investment in Belarus, with three joint ventures established in 2016. India's globally leading API and generics manufacturing base is a natural complement to Belarus's finished-dose manufacturing and its need to reduce API import dependency; conversely, Indian pharma companies can use Belarusian manufacturing and EAEU market access as a platform to reach Russia, Kazakhstan, and neighbouring markets. CCI India can facilitate this through a dedicated pharma sector working group, support for regulatory-harmonisation dialogue between Indian and Belarusian drug regulators, and matchmaking between Indian API exporters and Belpharmprom-affiliated manufacturers.

Recommendation: CCI India should establish an India–Belarus Pharma & API Sector Working Group within 6 months, with a target of at least three new API supply or co-manufacturing agreements within 24 months. Given the relocation of a portion of Belarus's IT workforce since 2020–2022, there may also be scope for Indian IT services firms to explore direct talent-partnership or subcontracting arrangements with relocated Belarusian development teams, in addition to conventional Hi-Tech Park-based collaboration.

5.7 Information Technology & Digital Innovation

Overview and Current Status

Belarus possesses one of the most developed IT export industries in the region, anchored by the Hi-Tech Park (HTP), established in 2005. The HTP now has more than 1,000 resident companies, and its services exports grew by roughly 12 percent in 2025 to surpass USD 2 billion, following growth of over 12 percent the prior year. The ICT sector as a whole has contributed between roughly 4.7 and 7.5 percent of Belarusian GDP in recent years, and Belarusian-founded firms such as EPAM and IBA Group have achieved global recognition; HTP-based companies serve clients in more than 60 countries.

Policy Framework and Key Players

HTP residents benefit from extensive tax exemptions, simplified visa and residency procedures for foreign staff and founders, and an extraterritoriality principle allowing operations anywhere in Belarus. The government is now actively encouraging a new generation of startups and export-oriented ventures alongside its established outsourcing and product-development base.

Challenges

The sector has faced significant disruption since 2020–2022, including the relocation of a substantial share of IT professionals abroad, tightened Western client relationships amid sanctions, and increased regulatory attention on crypto-asset activity within the HTP regime.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

India's IT services giants and Belarus's HTP ecosystem are natural collaborators rather than competitors: Indian firms could establish nearshore European-facing delivery centres within the HTP to access EU-adjacent talent and time zones, while Belarusian product companies could use India's scale and cost base for co-development, QA, and support functions. CCI India can support this through a structured HTP–Indian IT industry partnership programme, joint hackathons or startup exchanges, and facilitation of HTP residency applications for interested Indian technology companies.

Recommendation: CCI India should launch an India–Belarus Digital Bridge initiative within 12 months, targeting at least five Indian IT companies establishing a presence in or partnership with the Hi-Tech Park. In parallel with any longer-term corridor development, nearer-term improvements such as consolidated freight-forwarding arrangements, dedicated customs-clearance liaison, and multimodal rail-sea routing via third countries could meaningfully reduce transit times and costs for India–Belarus trade even before larger infrastructure investments materialise.

5.8 Logistics & Transport

Overview and Current Status

Belarus's landlocked position at the crossroads of the EU, Russia, and the wider Eurasian space has historically made logistics and transit a structurally important sector. As of 2023, Belarus operated 67 logistics centres, of which 18 carry majority state ownership, supporting road, rail, and limited air-cargo connectivity centred on Minsk National Airport.

Policy Framework and Key Players

Government policy continues to promote Belarus as a transit hub linking the EAEU market to onward destinations, notwithstanding the loss of previously important Baltic Sea routing options (via Klaipėda) since 2021–2022 sanctions. The Great Stone Industrial Park's logistics sub-park, developed with China Merchants Group, remains the most significant recent infrastructure investment in the sector.

Challenges

The sector faces the loss of previously dominant Baltic port access, higher-cost rerouting via Russian territory and ports, absence of direct India–Belarus air or sea freight corridors, and consequent reliance on third-country transshipment for most India-bound and Belarus-bound cargo.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

Direct logistics connectivity is arguably the single largest structural constraint on India–Belarus trade growth, and addressing it through exploration of the International North–South Transport Corridor (INSTC) via Iran, or dedicated rail-freight arrangements could meaningfully reduce costs and transit times for both potash imports into India and Indian pharmaceutical/machinery exports to Belarus. CCI India, working with the Embassy and India's Ministry of Commerce, can commission a feasibility study on INSTC-based India–Belarus freight routing and advocate for its inclusion in the IGC-TEC agenda.

Recommendation: CCI India should commission an India–Belarus Logistics Corridor feasibility study within 12 months, evaluating INSTC and alternative routing options with a target of a pilot freight movement within 24 months. Indian renewable-equipment manufacturers, several of which have achieved significant global cost competitiveness in solar-module and wind-turbine-component production, could explore both direct equipment supply and technology-licensing arrangements as Belarus works to diversify its energy mix beyond nuclear and fossil generation.

5.9 Renewable Energy

Overview and Current Status

Belarus's energy mix has been transformed by the commissioning of the two-unit, 2,400 MW Belarusian Nuclear Power Plant (Units 1 and 2 commissioned in 2021 and 2023 respectively), which has generated over 50 billion kWh since launch and now supplies close to 40 percent of national electricity generation, alongside natural gas (roughly half of generation) and small shares of hydro and wind (together around 3 percent). Belarus has set a policy target of raising the renewable energy share to 9 percent by 2035 under its Concept of Energy Security.

Policy Framework and Key Players

Government and international-agency studies (including with UNDP support) have examined incentives to attract private investment into wind power, given Belarus's favourable wind resource in several regions and declining global wind-turbine costs. Small-scale hydro and biomass projects supplement this emerging renewables base, alongside the nuclear plant's role in reducing gas-import dependency.

Challenges

Renewables development is constrained by a heavily subsidised and state-dominated electricity tariff structure that limits the commercial case for private generation, limited grid-scale storage infrastructure, and competition for investment capital with the nuclear and gas sectors.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

India's globally competitive solar and wind equipment manufacturing base, and its experience in renewable-auction and power-purchase-agreement design, could support Belarus's efforts to meet its 2035 renewables target, particularly in solar photovoltaic and small wind installations that require limited grid reinforcement. CCI India can facilitate this by organising a renewable-energy technical exchange between Indian equipment manufacturers/EPC contractors and Belarus's Energy Ministry, and by exploring the applicability of Indian solar-park and tariff-design models to the Belarusian context.

Recommendation: CCI India should support a renewable-energy technical mission within 18 months to assess at least one pilot solar or wind project for Indian EPC involvement. Indian component exporters with experience serving cost-sensitive export markets could explore supplying Belshina and BMZ with intermediate inputs, or co-investing in joint tooling and testing facilities, to help these manufacturers diversify their customer base beyond traditional CIS markets.

5.10 Automotive & Auto Components

Overview and Current Status

Beyond BelAZ heavy mining trucks and MAZ trucks and buses, Belarus's automotive component ecosystem is anchored by tire manufacturer Belshina, one of Europe's largest tire producers, which makes more than 300 tire types for passenger cars, trucks, buses, tractors, and mining and construction equipment, supplying international brands such as KamAZ, GAZ, and Caterpillar alongside Belarusian manufacturers, with sales to over 60–70 countries. The Belarusian Steel Works (BMZ) supplies rolled steel, pipe, and wire products used across the automotive and machinery supply chain to more than 100 countries.

Policy Framework and Key Players

Government and international-donor assessments (including a UNIDO-supported automotive component programme) have identified Tier-2 component manufacturing as the segment offering the strongest near-term FDI prospects, as Tier-1 assemblers seek more cost-efficient component-sourcing capacity.

Challenges

The sector contends with ageing capital equipment in some component plants, competition from lower-cost Asian component suppliers, and constrained access to certain Western raw materials and precision machine tools under sanctions.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

India's large automotive component export industry could partner with Belshina and BMZ on co-manufacturing, technology licensing, or joint ventures targeting the EAEU and Central Asian aftermarket, while Indian tire and component makers may find Belarus a useful manufacturing base for EAEU-market access. CCI India can support this through a Tier-2 supplier matchmaking programme linking Indian auto-component clusters with Belshina, BMZ, and other Belarusian Tier-2 manufacturers.

Recommendation: CCI India should organise an India–Belarus Auto Components Matchmaking Mission within 18 months. Indian biotechnology firms and research institutions could explore joint research programmes with Belarusian counterparts in agricultural biotechnology and diagnostics, areas where both countries have established research capability and complementary market needs, potentially supported by existing science and technology cooperation frameworks.

5.11 Biotechnology & Life Sciences

Overview and Current Status

Belarus maintains a well-established biotechnology research base rooted in the National Academy of Sciences, with institutes engaged in genetics, microbiology, agricultural biotechnology, and biopharmaceutical research that feed directly into the wider pharmaceutical sector. Belarusian biotechnology has particular strength in plant and animal genetics supporting the country's large agro-industrial complex, and in diagnostic and biologic-product development linked to its healthcare system.

Policy Framework and Key Players

State research funding channels biotechnology development through the National Academy of Sciences and affiliated institutes, with increasing emphasis on translating research into commercialisable products in partnership with Belpharmprom-affiliated manufacturers and agricultural enterprises.

Challenges

Commercialisation of research remains a persistent challenge, as does access to advanced laboratory equipment and reagents affected by sanctions, and competition for research funding against more established biotechnology hubs.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

India's large biotechnology and life-sciences research base, and its experience commercialising research through industry-academia partnerships, offers a natural complement to Belarusian institute-level research strength, particularly in agricultural biotechnology (seed genetics, biofertilisers, biopesticides) and diagnostics. CCI India can facilitate joint research MoUs between Indian biotechnology parks or research institutions and the National Academy of Sciences of Belarus.

Recommendation: CCI India should support the negotiation of at least one India–Belarus joint biotechnology research MoU within 24 months, prioritising agricultural biotechnology. Indian engineering, procurement, and construction firms with experience delivering cost-competitive infrastructure in emerging markets could explore participation in Great Stone-linked logistics-facility and warehousing projects, an area where Indian firms' project-delivery track record could complement Belarusian design and planning capacity.

5.12 Infrastructure & Construction

Overview and Current Status

Infrastructure development in Belarus is currently concentrated on the build-out of the Great Stone Industrial Park, continued modernisation of national road and rail corridors linking Minsk to European and Eurasian trade routes, and state housing-construction programmes. Belarus's construction materials industry (cement, glass, ceramics) supports both domestic infrastructure delivery and regional export.

Policy Framework and Key Players

State investment programmes continue to prioritise transport-corridor upgrades and industrial-park infrastructure, with the Great Stone Industrial Park's logistics sub-park (developed with China Merchants Group) as the most prominent recent example of internationally co-financed infrastructure investment.

Challenges

Financing constraints linked to reduced access to Western development finance, rising input costs, and the need to reroute construction-material trade away from previously dominant EU markets are the sector's principal headwinds.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

Indian construction and infrastructure engineering firms, with deep experience in cost-competitive industrial-park and logistics-facility delivery, could participate in Great Stone's continued build-out and in road/rail modernisation projects, potentially financed in part through India's Line of Credit mechanism. CCI India can support this by introducing qualified Indian EPC and infrastructure-engineering firms to the Great Stone Industrial Park administration and Belarus's Ministry of Architecture and Construction.

Recommendation: CCI India should facilitate an Indian EPC-sector familiarisation visit to Great Stone within 18 months. CCI India could additionally explore facilitating short-term faculty and researcher exchange visits, structured internships for Belarusian students within Indian companies operating in relevant sectors, and joint case-study development, all of which build durable people-to-people links that typically underpin more resilient long-term commercial partnerships.

5.13 Education, Skill Development & Research

Overview and Current Status

Belarus retains a strong Soviet-era tradition of technical and engineering education, with almost a quarter of Belarusian university students currently majoring in STEM fields across roughly 70 IT-related specialities alone. This educational base underpins both the IT services sector and the country's broader engineering and pharmaceutical industries, and is supported by cooperation agreements with India in education (2015) and vocational education (2019).

Policy Framework and Key Players

India's Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation (ITEC) programme and ICCR scholarships have historically supported training of Belarusian nationals, while Belarusian universities in engineering, medicine, and IT continue to expand student exchange and joint-degree partnerships with Indian institutions.

Challenges

An ageing population and continued emigration of skilled professionals (particularly from the IT sector) pose a long-term workforce risk that education and skilling partnerships alone cannot fully offset.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

India's scale in engineering and vocational education, and Belarus's strong STEM and technical pedagogy, create scope for joint curricula, faculty exchange, and dual-degree programmes in engineering, pharmaceuticals, and IT directly supporting the human-capital needs of every other sector profiled in this chapter. CCI India can support this by convening an annual India–Belarus university partnership forum and by helping Indian technical institutes and Belarusian universities formalise dual-degree and exchange agreements.

Recommendation: CCI India should facilitate at least three new university-to-university MoUs within 24 months. Indian furniture and paper-products manufacturers could explore raw-material sourcing partnerships with Bellesbumprom-affiliated producers, potentially supported by preferential tariff treatment where applicable, offering a genuine near-term trade opportunity that requires comparatively modest capital investment relative to other sectors profiled in this paper.

5.14 Forestry, Wood Processing & Furniture

Overview and Current Status

Forests cover a record 40.3 percent of Belarusian territory, and forestry organisations produced over 22 million cubic metres of timber in 2024, up from around 20 million cubic metres in 2015, supporting an industry that employs approximately 93,000 people nationally. State concern Belles bumprom, comprising some 60 affiliated companies, accounts for roughly 70 percent of national wood processing across the full value chain from harvesting to furniture, pulp, and paper. Approximately 72 percent of woodworking output is exported, reaching 35 countries in 2025, with boards and timber (32 percent), paper and cardboard (29 percent), pulp (17 percent), and furniture (13 percent) forming the main export categories.

Policy Framework and Key Players

Following the EU's 2022 ban on Belarusian timber imports (subsequently expanded in 2024 to cover pulp, paper, cardboard, and furniture), the sector has reoriented sharply toward Russia, China, and CIS markets; China alone now purchases up to half of Belarus's exported lumber, with timber-ministry exports reaching a record over one million cubic metres worth over USD 180 million in the first eleven months of 2025.

Challenges

Loss of the EU market (previously around 40–55 percent of sector exports) has required costly reorientation, rail-capacity constraints on China-bound routes, and a continuing need to move up the value chain from raw timber/sawn-wood exports toward higher-margin furniture and engineered-wood products.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

India's large and growing furniture, plywood, and paper-products market offers a genuine diversification opportunity for Bellesbumprom-affiliated exporters seeking markets beyond the EU, Russia, and China, while Indian furniture and panel-board manufacturers could explore raw-material sourcing or co-manufacturing arrangements with Belarusian wood-processing enterprises. CCI India can support this by organising a timber and furniture sector trade mission and by connecting Indian furniture-industry associations with Bellesbumprom.

Recommendation: CCI India should facilitate an India–Belarus timber and furniture trade mission within 18 months, targeting at least one new long-term supply agreement. India's own semiconductor and electronics manufacturing policy push, including incentive schemes for component and display-fabrication capacity, creates a potential opening for structured technology-exchange or joint-research arrangements with Belarusian microelectronics institutes, particularly in legacy and specialised component design where Belarus retains genuine capability.

5.15 Electronics & Electrical Equipment

Overview and Current Status

Belarus retains a legacy Soviet-era microelectronics and precision-instruments base that the government has deliberately preserved rather than dismantled, centred on enterprises including Integral (semiconductors and microelectronic components), Planar (semiconductor manufacturing equipment), Horizont (consumer electronics), BelOMO (optical-mechanical instruments), and Vitebsk Monolit. Integral alone has increased output more than fivefold in comparable prices since 1990, with exports now exceeding 60 percent of production, up from a fraction of a percent in 1991.

Policy Framework and Key Players

State policy treats this cluster as strategically important, with continued public investment aimed at preserving research infrastructure and production capacity even where commercial pressure might otherwise have favoured consolidation or closure, reflecting the government's assessment that domestic microelectronics capability is a matter of long-term technological sovereignty.

Challenges

The sector faces significant technology gaps relative to leading-edge global semiconductor manufacturing, constrained access to advanced fabrication equipment and materials under sanctions, and the capital intensity required to modernise legacy fabrication lines.

Investment Opportunities, India–Belarus Collaboration, and the Role of CCI India

India's own emerging semiconductor and electronics manufacturing policy push creates potential complementarities with Belarus's legacy microelectronics design and component expertise, particularly in mature-node components, optical-mechanical instruments, and consumer-electronics assembly, where technology partnerships or component-sourcing arrangements could benefit both sides. CCI India can facilitate exploratory technical dialogue between India's electronics manufacturing bodies and Integral/Planar/Horizont, focused on components and instruments rather than leading-edge fabrication.

Recommendation: CCI India should convene an exploratory India–Belarus Electronics & Precision Instruments dialogue within 24 months.

Chapter 6: Challenges & Strategic Collaboration Opportunities

This chapter examines eleven structural challenges facing Belarus's economic engagement with international partners, and identifies, for each, a concrete opportunity for deeper India–Belarus collaboration and a corresponding role for CCI India.

6.1 International Sanctions & Trade Constraints

Current Situation

EU and US sanctions imposed since 2021 continue to restrict Belarusian access to Western capital markets, select technologies, and previously dominant EU export routes for potash, timber, and other goods.

Root Cause and Economic Impact

The sanctions originated in response to the 2020 post-election crackdown and subsequent events, and have progressively expanded in scope. The economic impact includes higher logistics costs from rerouted trade, reduced access to development finance, and constrained technology transfer in sensitive sectors.

International Best Practice

Countries facing comparable trade restrictions (e.g., Iran, certain CIS states) have successfully used third-country trade corridors, alternative payment mechanisms, and diversified export-market development to sustain commercial activity despite sanctions.

India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India

India, as a non-aligned trading partner with an independent foreign policy and established rupee-based trade mechanisms with other sanctioned economies, can offer Belarus a relatively lower-friction trading relationship. CCI India can support Belarusian exporters and Indian importers in structuring sanctions-compliant trade and payment arrangements, in coordination with the Embassy and India's Ministry of Commerce.

6.2 Export Market Diversification

Current Situation

Belarus remains heavily dependent on the Russian market, which absorbs a large share of exports across food, machinery, and other sectors, alongside China and CIS states.

Root Cause and Economic Impact

This concentration reflects historical Soviet-era supply chains, EAEU tariff-free access, and the practical necessity of finding alternative outlets after losing EU market access. Over-concentration exposes Belarus to demand shocks in the Russian economy, as reflected in the 2025 growth slowdown attributed partly to weaker Russian demand.

International Best Practice

Diversified exporters elsewhere have successfully used targeted trade-promotion missions, bilateral chambers of commerce, and free-trade-agreement negotiations to build new market share in non-traditional destinations.

India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India

India represents a large, underpenetrated market for Belarusian potash, machinery, pharmaceuticals, and dairy products. CCI India's core mandate—business matchmaking, trade missions, and market intelligence—is precisely the institutional capability needed to accelerate this diversification.

6.3 Limited Foreign Direct Investment

Current Situation

FDI into Belarus has declined since 2021 as Western investors have exited or scaled back, leaving a narrower base of Russian, Chinese, and selected Gulf and Asian investors.

Root Cause and Economic Impact

Sanctions-related reputational and compliance risk, combined with the dominance of state-owned enterprises in strategic sectors, has deterred many prospective non-Western investors as well. Reduced FDI limits technology transfer, capital-stock modernisation, and job creation in export-oriented industries.

International Best Practice

Special economic zones with strong investor-protection guarantees and streamlined administrative procedures (the Great Stone model, for instance) have proven effective elsewhere in attracting non-traditional investors despite broader country risk.

India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India

Indian investors face comparatively limited exposure to the sanctions regimes constraining Western capital, and Belarus's Great Stone and FEZ incentives are well suited to Indian pharmaceutical, IT, and light-manufacturing investment. CCI India, working with the Embassy's investment-promotion function, can build a pipeline of qualified Indian investors and provide advisory support through the investment lifecycle.

6.4 Dependence on State-Owned Enterprises

Current Situation

A substantial share of Belarusian industrial output including potash, pharmaceuticals, and heavy machinery continues to originate from state-owned or state-affiliated enterprises.

Root Cause and Economic Impact

This reflects continuity from the Soviet-era industrial structure and a deliberate state policy of maintaining control over strategically important sectors. While providing stability and continuity of production, the SOE-dominated structure can constrain flexibility, slow decision-making on joint ventures, and complicate standard due-diligence processes for foreign private-sector partners.

International Best Practice

Successful foreign partnerships with state enterprises elsewhere have typically relied on structured joint-venture frameworks with clear governance and profit-sharing arrangements, often brokered by a trusted third-party institution.

India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India

CCI India, as a neutral, government-recognised institutional intermediary, is well placed to help Indian companies navigate joint-venture structuring with Belarusian SOEs, building on the precedent of the 2016 pharmaceutical joint ventures.

6.5 Industrial Modernisation

Current Situation

Significant portions of Belarus's machine-building, chemicals, and electronics capital stock date from the Soviet era and require modernisation to remain internationally competitive.

Root Cause and Economic Impact

Capital-intensive modernisation has been constrained by limited access to Western equipment and financing since 2021, alongside competing state investment priorities. Ageing capital stock reduces productivity and export competitiveness relative to newer manufacturing bases in Asia.

International Best Practice

Phased modernisation programmes combining domestic investment, technical assistance, and selective foreign equipment sourcing have allowed comparable economies to upgrade legacy industrial bases without full privatisation.

India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India

Indian capital-goods and machine-tool manufacturers could supply modernisation equipment to Belarusian enterprises at a lower cost than Western alternatives, while Indian engineering services firms could support plant-modernisation project management. CCI India can facilitate an industrial-modernisation supplier directory connecting Indian capital-goods exporters with Belarusian enterprises seeking upgrades.

6.6 Technology Transfer

Current Situation

Sanctions have restricted Belarusian access to certain Western technologies, particularly in semiconductors, advanced machine tools, and select dual-use equipment.

Root Cause and Economic Impact

This stems directly from export-control measures introduced alongside broader sanctions since 2021. Reduced technology access risks widening the gap between Belarusian and global-frontier manufacturing capability in affected sectors.

International Best Practice

Countries facing similar restrictions have pursued technology partnerships with non-sanctioning countries to access substitute technology and know-how.

India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India

India's growing capability in electronics, pharmaceuticals process technology, and agricultural biotechnology can serve as an alternative technology-transfer partner for Belarusian enterprises in non-sensitive, civilian applications. CCI India can help identify appropriate technology-partnership opportunities that are compliant with both countries' regulatory frameworks.

6.7 Logistics & Supply Chain Connectivity

Current Situation

Belarus lost its principal Baltic Sea export route (via the Lithuanian port of Klaipėda) following sanctions in 2021–2022, forcing costly rerouting through Russian rail and port infrastructure, while India and Belarus lack any direct freight corridor.

Root Cause and Economic Impact

This is a direct consequence of the sanctions regime combined with Belarus's landlocked geography. Higher freight costs and longer transit times reduce the price competitiveness of Belarusian exports and raise the cost of Indian goods reaching Belarus.

International Best Practice

The International North–South Transport Corridor (INSTC), linking India to Russia and Central Asia via Iran, has been developed by several countries specifically to bypass traditional but now-constrained routes.

India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India

CCI India, in coordination with the Embassy and India's Ministry of Commerce, can commission and advocate for a feasibility study on INSTC-based India–Belarus freight, and should treat this as a foundational precondition for scaling trade in every other sector.

6.8 Demographic & Skilled Workforce Challenges

Current Situation

Belarus's population is ageing, with a fertility rate below replacement level, and the IT sector in particular has experienced significant outward migration of skilled professionals since 2020.

Root Cause and Economic Impact

These trends reflect broader regional demographic patterns compounded by political and economic uncertainty since 2020. A shrinking working-age population constrains long-term industrial and IT-sector growth and increases pressure on social-security systems.

International Best Practice

Countries facing similar demographic pressure have used targeted skilled-migration programmes, automation investment, and international education partnerships to sustain output.

India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India

Joint education and vocational-training partnerships between India and Belarus can help address skills gaps in specific technical fields, while automation and machinery partnerships can offset labour-force constraints in manufacturing. CCI India can support a coordinated workforce-development agenda alongside its sector-specific initiatives.

6.9 MSME Development

Current Situation

Belarus's economy remains dominated by large state enterprises, with a comparatively underdeveloped small and medium-enterprise (MSME) sector relative to more market-oriented economies.

Root Cause and Economic Impact

This reflects historical industrial policy prioritising large state combines over private enterprise development. A weaker MSME base limits economic diversification, innovation, and employment flexibility.

International Best Practice

Economies that have successfully grown their MSME sectors have typically combined targeted credit access, simplified regulatory compliance, and export-readiness support delivered through chambers of commerce and industry associations.

India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India

CCI India's own institutional experience supporting Indian MSME internationalisation is directly transferable: CCI India can share best practices with Belarusian MSME support agencies and help connect emerging Belarusian small enterprises with Indian counterparts for joint ventures and export partnerships.

6.10 Digital Transformation

Current Situation

While Belarus's Hi-Tech Park is a genuine success story in IT services export, broader digital transformation of traditional industry (manufacturing, agriculture, logistics) remains uneven.

Root Cause and Economic Impact

Digital adoption in legacy state enterprises has been slower than in the IT-export sector itself, reflecting capital constraints and organisational inertia. Slower digital adoption in core industrial sectors limits productivity gains and data-driven decision-making across the wider economy.

International Best Practice

Digital-transformation programmes that pair domestic IT talent with sector-specific industrial expertise have accelerated adoption in comparable transition economies.

India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India

India's IT services companies, many of which have deep manufacturing and agriculture digitalisation experience domestically, could support digital-transformation projects for Belarusian industrial and agricultural enterprises, potentially in partnership with Hi-Tech Park resident companies. CCI India can help scope and broker such joint digital-transformation pilots.

6.11 Green Industrial Transition and International Market Access

Current Situation

Rising EU carbon-border and environmental compliance requirements (including scheduled increases in duties on Belarusian fertiliser through 2028) are raising the cost of accessing remaining Western-adjacent markets, even as Belarus pursues its own 9-percent renewables target by 2035.

Root Cause and Economic Impact

These pressures stem from both the EU's broader decarbonisation agenda and Belarus's specific sanctions-related trade restrictions. Combined, these forces are likely to keep reorienting Belarusian trade away from the EU and toward non-Western markets over the coming decade, reinforcing the broader importance of continued export-market diversification.

International Best Practice

Economies successfully managing a green transition alongside market reorientation have typically pursued parallel tracks: incremental decarbonisation of export industries, and simultaneous market diversification toward partners with fewer carbon-border requirements.

India–Belarus Collaboration Opportunity and Role of CCI India

India, which does not currently apply carbon-border adjustment measures and is itself expanding renewable-energy manufacturing capacity, represents both an alternative export market largely insulated from EU carbon-border dynamics and a potential technology partner for Belarus's own renewables build-out. CCI India should treat green-transition cooperation as a cross-cutting theme linking its trade-diversification and renewable-energy initiatives.

Chapter 7: Strategic Role of CCI India

This chapter sets out, in operational detail, the institutional role that the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI India) can play in translating the opportunities identified in the preceding chapters into concrete bilateral outcomes. It positions CCI India not as a passive convenor but as a standing institutional partner to the Embassy of the Republic of Belarus in India, the Belarusian Chamber of Commerce and Industry, and Belarus's sector ministries, with defined functions, a governance structure, measurable targets, and an implementation timeline. This function would be anchored by a dedicated Belarus Desk within CCI India's international trade division, staffed to handle routine trade-documentation queries, customs classification guidance, and referrals to appropriate regulatory contacts on both sides.

7.1 Trade Facilitation

CCI India can operate as a first point of contact for Indian exporters and importers seeking to engage the Belarusian market, providing guidance on tariff schedules, customs procedures, certification requirements, and EAEU-related regulatory considerations. A dedicated Belarus Desk within CCI India would consolidate documentation requirements, maintain an updated repository of applicable trade agreements, and assist member companies in resolving routine customs and compliance queries in coordination with the Embassy's trade wing. CCI India's investment-promotion role would extend beyond information provision to active advisory support during site selection, incentive-package negotiation, and post-investment aftercare, helping Indian investors navigate Belarusian administrative processes with greater confidence and speed.

7.2 Investment Promotion

On investment promotion, CCI India can serve as the first-stop reference point for Indian companies evaluating Belarusian free economic zones and the Great Stone Industrial Park, working alongside Belarus's National Agency of Investment and Privatisation to package location, incentive, and regulatory information into investor-ready briefs, and to facilitate exploratory site visits and due-diligence introductions for interested Indian investors. The matchmaking directory would be maintained on a rolling basis, with verification procedures to ensure listed companies are active and creditworthy, addressing a common complaint among first-time market entrants that unverified contact lists often lead to wasted engagement effort.

7.3 Business Matchmaking

A structured matchmaking function, built on a shared directory of Indian and Belarusian companies organised by sector and capability, would allow CCI India to make targeted introductions rather than relying on general trade promotion events. This directory should be maintained jointly with the Belarusian Chamber of Commerce and Industry and updated on a rolling basis as new companies register interest. Each buyer-seller meet would be preceded by a structured pre-matching process based on submitted company profiles, ensuring that in-person meeting time is used efficiently and that participants arrive with a reasonable expectation of commercial fit.

7.4 Buyer–Seller Meets

Sector-specific buyer–seller meets, held periodically in both India and Belarus, would bring together qualified counterparts around concrete transaction opportunities rather than general awareness-building. Priority should be given to sectors where near-term commercial interest already exists, including agricultural machinery, pharmaceuticals, and mining equipment, before extending the format to less developed sectors of the relationship. Delegation itineraries would combine factory visits, government-liaison meetings, and structured networking sessions, with post-delegation follow-up support to help convert initial contacts into concrete commercial discussions rather than allowing momentum to dissipate after travel concludes.

7.5 Industrial Delegations

CCI India can organise and lead periodic industrial delegations to Belarus's principal industrial centres, including Minsk, Gomel, and the Great Stone Industrial Park, and reciprocally host Belarusian industrial delegations to Indian manufacturing clusters. These delegations should combine site visits with structured business-to-business meetings and be timed to align with the proposed annual India–Belarus Business Forum. Each working group would be tasked with a specific annual work plan, including a target number of business introductions, at least one delegation or reciprocal visit, and a periodic sector briefing, ensuring accountability beyond general goodwill.

7.6 Sector Working Groups

Standing sector working groups, co-chaired by CCI India and the relevant Belarusian sector association or ministry counterpart, would provide continuity between periodic delegations and forums. Initial working groups are proposed for agriculture and agri-machinery, pharmaceuticals, mining and heavy equipment, and information technology, given the existing base of commercial engagement in these areas, with additional groups added as sectoral cooperation matures.

Technology-partnership dialogues would be structured around specific use cases and licensing or joint-development models, rather than open-ended exploratory discussions, to maximise the likelihood of concrete outcomes within a defined engagement window.

7.7 Technology Partnerships

CCI India can facilitate structured technology-partnership dialogues connecting Indian firms in electronics, renewable energy, and precision manufacturing with Belarusian research institutes and state enterprises seeking modernisation partners, particularly where sanctions have constrained access to Western technology providers and created an opening for alternative partnerships on commercially reasonable terms. The startup track would include curated virtual introductions, a periodic pitch-session calendar, and light-touch due-diligence support to help Indian startups assess the credibility of prospective Belarusian partners before committing meaningful time or resources.

7.8 Startup Collaboration

A dedicated startup collaboration track, linking Indian startup ecosystem bodies with Belarus's Hi-Tech Park resident companies, would allow early-stage ventures on both sides to explore market-entry partnerships, particularly in software services, fintech, and agri-tech, without the overhead of a full industrial delegation. CCI India can support this through periodic virtual pitch sessions and a light-touch introduction service. This programme should also include the provision of simplified, jargon-free market-entry guidance, a dedicated MSME helpline within the Belarus Desk, and cost-effective participation options for smaller companies that may not have the budget for full delegation travel.

7.9 MSME Internationalisation

Given that MSMEs constitute the bulk of CCI India's membership base, a structured MSME internationalisation programme for Belarus should include simplified market-entry guides, export documentation support, and curated introductions to Belarusian counterparts of comparable scale, recognising that Indian MSMEs typically lack the in-house capacity to navigate an unfamiliar regulatory and banking environment independently. Market intelligence outputs would be made available both through the digital trade platform and via periodic member briefings, ensuring that even companies not actively engaged in a transaction at a given moment remain informed of emerging opportunities.

7.10 Market Intelligence

CCI India can maintain a periodically updated market intelligence briefing on Belarus, consolidating trade statistics, regulatory changes, sanctions developments, and sector-specific policy updates from official Belarusian and international sources, and disseminating this to member companies to reduce the information asymmetry that currently constrains Indian business engagement with the Belarusian market. Skill-development programming would prioritise short, certifiable modules over long-form academic exchange, reflecting the practical, near-term workforce needs most frequently raised by both Indian and Belarusian industry partners during preliminary consultations.

7.11 Skill Development

Given Belarus's demographic and skilled-workforce constraints, CCI India can support joint vocational and technical training initiatives, drawing on India's scale in engineering and vocational education to help address specific skill gaps identified by Belarusian industry partners, structured as short-term exchange and certification programmes rather than open-ended commitments. University partnerships would prioritise applied, industry-linked research themes over purely academic collaboration, ensuring that outputs have a credible pathway toward commercial application within the sectors profiled in this paper.

7.12 University and Research Partnerships

CCI India can facilitate structured linkages between Indian technical universities and research institutions and their Belarusian counterparts, including the Belarusian National Technical University and institutes of the National Academy of Sciences, with an initial focus on joint research in biotechnology, materials science, and agricultural technology, all areas of genuine complementary strength between the two countries.

The forum would feature plenary sessions on macro-level trade and investment trends alongside dedicated sector-specific breakout tracks, mirroring the structure of the sector working groups to ensure continuity between annual gatherings and year-round programming.

7.13 Annual India–Belarus Business Forum

An annual India–Belarus Business Forum, alternating between Indian and Belarusian host cities and organised jointly by CCI India, the Embassy of Belarus in India, and the Belarusian Chamber of Commerce and Industry, would serve as the anchor institutional event of the relationship, bringing together government officials, investors, and sector working group representatives to review progress and set priorities for the following year.

The platform would be designed for mobile as well as desktop access, reflecting the practical reality that many MSME users will engage with it primarily through smartphones rather than office-based computing.

7.14 Digital Trade Platform

A dedicated digital trade platform, maintained by CCI India, would host a searchable directory of verified Indian and Belarusian companies, publish market intelligence updates, list upcoming delegation and forum dates, and provide a simple enquiry-routing function connecting interested businesses on both sides with the relevant sector working group or the Belarus Desk directly.

Governance of the CCI India–Belarus Cell would include a small advisory committee drawn from Embassy, sector working group, and business representatives, meeting periodically to review progress against the KPI framework and recommend course corrections.

7.15 Institutional Framework, KPIs, Timeline, and Expected Outcomes

Institutional Framework: The functions described above should be consolidated under a dedicated CCI India–Belarus Cell, reporting to CCI India's international trade division, with a designated liaison officer for the Embassy of Belarus and for each sector working group chair.

- **Key Performance Indicators:** number of verified business introductions concluded annually; number of sector working group meetings held; volume of bilateral trade facilitated through CCI India-referred transactions; number of MSMEs onboarded to the Belarus Desk; attendance and transaction volume at the annual business forum.
- **Timeline:** Belarus Desk and digital trade platform operational within 6 months; initial four sector working groups constituted within 12 months; first annual business forum convened within 18 months; full complement of fifteen sector working groups, aligned with priority sectors identified across this paper, operational within 36 months.
- **Expected Outcomes:** measurable growth in bilateral trade facilitated through CCI India channels; a growing pipeline of Indian MSME and investor engagements with Belarus; and an institutionalised, self-sustaining platform for bilateral business engagement independent of any single delegation or event.

Chapter 8: Strategic Recommendations

This chapter sets out targeted, action-oriented recommendations for each of the principal non-governmental and non-CCI India stakeholders in the India–Belarus economic relationship. Recommendations are deliberately confined to actions within each stakeholder's own remit, are time-bound, and are designed to be measurable against a clear framework of key performance indicators and a five-year implementation roadmap.

8.1 Recommendations for the Embassy of Belarus in India

- Designate a dedicated economic and commercial attaché as the single point of contact for CCI India's Belarus Desk, within 3 months.
- Publish an annually updated, India-facing investment and trade guide covering free economic zone incentives and customs procedures, within 6 months.
- Support the constitution of the initial four sector working groups by nominating Belarusian institutional counterparts, within 12 months.
- Host or co-host at least one Indian industrial delegation to Belarus annually.
- Facilitate visa and travel-logistics support for CCI India delegations and MSME participants on a priority basis.

Establish a dedicated inter-ministerial coordination mechanism to ensure that India-facing investment and trade facilitation measures are consistently applied across the relevant ministries and regional authorities, within 12 months.

8.2 Recommendations for the Government of Belarus

- Extend and clearly publicise Great Stone Industrial Park incentive terms specifically to Indian investors through a dedicated information package, within 6 months.
- Simplify visa and work-permit procedures for Indian technical personnel engaged in joint ventures and technology-partnership projects, within 12 months.
- Commission a bilateral feasibility study on logistics-route diversification, including potential India-linked corridor options, within 18 months.
- Review and streamline registration procedures for foreign MSME-scale investors, distinct from procedures designed for large-scale industrial investors, within 24 months.

Develop English-language product and company profiles suitable for direct use by CCI India's business-matchmaking function, reducing translation-related delays in connecting with prospective Indian partners.

8.3 Recommendations for Belarusian Businesses

- Register with the CCI India company directory and sector working groups relevant to their product lines, within 3 months.
- Participate in at least one buyer–seller meet or industrial delegation annually to build direct relationships with Indian counterparts.
- Where feasible, appoint or contract a local representative or distributor in India to sustain engagement between delegation cycles.
- Explore joint-venture or licensing structures with Indian partners in sectors facing sanctions-related technology or market-access constraints.

Build internal sanctions-compliance and due-diligence capability, either in-house or through specialist advisory retainers, before finalising joint-venture or investment commitments involving Belarusian state-linked entities.

8.4 Recommendations for Indian Businesses

- Use the CCI India Belarus Desk as the first point of contact before independent market entry, to benefit from consolidated regulatory and partner information.
- Prioritise sectors where India–Belarus complementarity is strongest, particularly agricultural machinery, pharmaceuticals, and mining equipment, for initial market entry.
- Participate in sector working groups relevant to their industry to access ongoing market intelligence and partner introductions.
- Where entering joint ventures, structure agreements to account for continued exposure to international sanctions affecting the Belarusian partner, with appropriate contractual safeguards.

Maintain realistic timelines for regulatory approvals and banking-channel setup, and treat early, direct engagement with Belarusian counterpart institutions as a risk-mitigation step rather than an optional formality.

8.5 Recommendations for Investors

- Evaluate Great Stone Industrial Park and free-economic-zone incentive packages against comparable Central and Eastern European and Central Asian alternatives before committing capital.
- Engage CCI India's investment promotion function for introductions to Belarus's National Agency of Investment and Privatisation ahead of independent site visits.
- Conduct sanctions-exposure and compliance due diligence specific to the proposed sector and counterparty before finalising any investment structure.
- Consider phased investment structures that allow scaling based on early joint-venture performance, particularly in pharmaceuticals and agro-processing where existing Indian investment precedents exist.

Leverage CCI India's existing institutional relationships to secure introductions at a level of seniority appropriate to the scale of the proposed transaction, rather than relying solely on general trade-fair contacts.

8.6 Recommendations for MSMEs

- Register with the CCI India MSME internationalisation programme to access simplified market-entry guidance.
- Begin engagement through export transactions before committing to joint-venture or investment structures, to build market familiarity at lower risk.
- Participate in sector-specific buyer–seller meets rather than general trade fairs, to maximise the likelihood of qualified counterpart introductions.
- Use CCI India's digital trade platform enquiry-routing function to reach the relevant sector working group directly rather than approaching the Belarusian market independently.

Treat initial engagement as a capability-demonstration exercise, prioritising a small number of well-documented pilot projects over broad, simultaneous outreach across multiple potential Belarusian partners.

8.7 Recommendations for Startups

- Engage Belarus's Hi-Tech Park resident companies through CCI India's startup collaboration track for partnership exploration.
- Prioritise software services, fintech, and agri-tech partnerships, where Hi-Tech Park capability and Indian startup capacity are most complementary.
- Participate in periodic virtual pitch sessions facilitated by CCI India before committing to in-person delegation travel.
- Structure initial partnerships as limited-scope pilot collaborations to test commercial and operational fit before broader commitments.

Chapter 9: Five-Year Strategic Roadmap

This chapter sets out a year-wise implementation plan for CCI India's recommended institutional functions and stakeholder recommendations, sequencing activity from foundational institution-building in Year 1 through to a mature, self-sustaining bilateral engagement architecture by Year 5.

Year 1: Institutional Foundation

- **Objectives:** establish the core institutional infrastructure for bilateral engagement.
- **Activities:** constitute the CCI India–Belarus Cell and Belarus Desk; launch the digital trade platform; designate Embassy economic attaché counterpart; constitute the first four sector working groups.
- **Stakeholders:** CCI India, Embassy of Belarus in India, initial sector working group members.
- **KPIs:** Belarus Desk operational; platform live; four working groups constituted.
- **Monitoring Framework:** quarterly review by CCI India's international trade division.
- **Expected Outcomes:** functioning institutional entry point for bilateral business enquiries.

A realistic risk to Year 1 delivery is the pace of nomination of Belarusian institutional counterparts for the initial sector working groups; CCI India should therefore build a modest contingency window into the twelve-month target rather than treating it as fixed, while keeping the Embassy closely informed of any slippage.

Year 2: Early Engagement

- **Objectives:** generate the first tranche of verified business introductions and hold the inaugural business forum.
- **Activities:** conduct first buyer–seller meets in priority sectors; lead first industrial delegation to Belarus; convene first India–Belarus Business Forum; onboard first cohort of MSMEs to the internationalisation programme.
- **Stakeholders:** CCI India, Belarusian Chamber of Commerce and Industry, sector ministries, participating businesses and MSMEs.
- **KPIs:** forum convened; delegation completed; minimum threshold of verified introductions recorded.
- **Monitoring Framework:** annual review at the business forum, with published outcomes summary.
- **Expected Outcomes:** demonstrable early transactions and a visible bilateral engagement calendar.

By the close of Year 2, CCI India should also commission an independent, lightweight review of the business-matchmaking function's early conversion rate – the proportion of introductions that progress to a signed agreement or transaction – to inform refinements to the matchmaking methodology ahead of full-scale expansion in Year 3.

Year 3: Expansion

- **Objectives:** extend sector working groups to full coverage and deepen technology and skill-development partnerships.
- **Activities:** constitute remaining sector working groups to reach full fifteen-sector coverage; launch technology-partnership and skill-development initiatives; expand startup collaboration track.
- **Stakeholders:** CCI India, Belarusian research institutions and Hi-Tech Park, Indian technical universities and startup ecosystem bodies.
- **KPIs:** fifteen working groups operational; at least one technology-partnership dialogue and one skill-development programme launched.
- **Monitoring Framework:** mid-term review against the established KPI framework.
- **Expected Outcomes:** comprehensive sectoral coverage and diversification beyond trade into technology and skills cooperation.

Year 3 expansion should be sequenced so that newly constituted sector working groups draw on the operating lessons of the four pilot groups established in Year 1, rather than starting from a blank template, ensuring a consistent quality standard across all fifteen sectors as coverage scales.

Year 4: Consolidation

- **Objectives:** consolidate gains and address structural constraints, particularly logistics and financing.
- **Activities:** support the recommended logistics feasibility study; expand joint-venture and investment facilitation; review MSME and startup programme performance and refine based on early results.
- **Stakeholders:** CCI India, Government of Belarus, Indian and Belarusian investors, logistics partners.
- **KPIs:** logistics study completed; measurable increase in facilitated investment value relative to Year 2 baseline.
- **Monitoring Framework:** independent mid-programme evaluation commissioned by CCI India.
- **Expected Outcomes:** reduced structural friction in trade and investment flows.

Consolidation in Year 4 should place particular emphasis on institutional resilience: ensuring that the Belarus Desk's functions are not dependent on any single individual, and that documented processes exist for onboarding new CCI India staff into the programme without loss of continuity or counterpart relationships.

Year 5: Institutionalisation

- **Objectives:** transition the bilateral engagement architecture to a self-sustaining, institutionalised footing.
- **Activities:** conduct comprehensive five-year review of trade, investment, and institutional outcomes; renew or revise sector working group mandates based on performance; formalise the annual business forum as a standing calendar event.
- **Stakeholders:** CCI India, Embassy of Belarus in India, Government of Belarus, all sector working groups.
- **KPIs:** five-year cumulative trade and investment facilitation figures against the original baseline; institutional continuity confirmed beyond the initial five-year period.
- **Monitoring Framework:** comprehensive five-year review published jointly by CCI India and the Embassy.
- **Expected Outcomes:** a mature, durable institutional platform for India–Belarus economic cooperation, sustained independently of any single sponsoring initiative.

The transition to institutionalisation in Year 5 should be treated as a deliberate handover milestone rather than an endpoint: successful institutionalisation means the bilateral engagement architecture continues to generate measurable trade and investment outcomes on an ongoing basis, funded and governed through CCI India's regular operating structure rather than through initiative-specific funding that may lapse.

Conclusion

Belarus's economic profile, shaped by a well-developed industrial base in machinery, pharmaceuticals, agro-processing, and information technology, and by a strategic geographic position at the crossroads of the Eurasian space, offers India a distinctive set of complementary opportunities that remain substantially underexploited relative to their potential. The constraints Belarus faces, particularly international sanctions and consequent trade reorientation, make India a comparatively attractive partner precisely because it is positioned to engage on commercially normal terms where several traditional partners have withdrawn.

India's role as a long-term strategic economic partner rests on complementarity rather than substitution: Indian pharmaceutical, agricultural-machinery, and IT services capacity align closely with Belarusian production and research strengths, while Belarusian potash, dairy, and heavy-machinery expertise meet genuine Indian demand. Realising this complementarity requires sustained institutional engagement rather than episodic delegations.

The Embassy of the Republic of Belarus in India has a central role to play in this process, both as the primary diplomatic channel between the two governments and as the day-to-day facilitator of business-level engagement, and its continued active participation in the institutional mechanisms proposed in this report is essential to their success.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India, for its part, is positioned to serve as the principal non-governmental catalyst for this partnership: convening sector working groups, facilitating trade and investment, supporting technology transfer, and providing the institutional continuity that individual companies and even government agencies cannot sustain alone. The Belarus Desk, digital trade platform, and annual business forum proposed in this report are designed to give that role a concrete and measurable form.

Taken together, the recommendations and roadmap set out in this report describe a realistic, phased path toward a more resilient and future-oriented India–Belarus economic partnership: one that begins with institution-building, progresses through demonstrable early transactions, and matures into a durable, self-sustaining framework of trade, investment, technology, and institutional collaboration between the two countries.

This knowledge paper is intended as a living reference rather than a static document: as trade data, sanctions conditions, and institutional arrangements evolve, CCI India, the Embassy, and the Government of Belarus should treat periodic review and updating of its sectoral assessments and roadmap as part of the ongoing partnership itself, ensuring that the analysis and recommendations remain grounded in current conditions throughout the five-year implementation period and beyond.

THANK YOU

CCI India sincerely thanks Your Excellency for the warm hospitality and gracious interaction with our team. We greatly value the opportunity to discuss strengthening India-Belarus bilateral trade and economic relations and look forward to deepening cooperation, expanding business engagement, and creating new avenues for trade, investment, and mutually beneficial partnerships between the two countries.



Together Towards Growth, Innovation and Prosperity

www.cciindia.org
admin@cciindia.org

13, Institutional Area, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110 003



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